Codebook — gss2024.csv

General Social Survey 2024 — team project extract

About this dataset

The General Social Survey (GSS) has surveyed a nationally representative sample of adults in the United States since 1972 and is one of the most widely used sources of data in the social sciences. This file is an extract from the 2024 cross-section, collected by NORC at the University of Chicago.

The GSS does not ask every question of every respondent. The questionnaire is split across ballots, and a respondent answers only the modules on their ballot. This extract keeps the 1,868 respondents who were asked how often they use the media for political news, so that every variable below is available for the same group of people. That is why the numbers here are smaller than the 3,986 respondents in the full 2024 survey. The other two team-project datasets have been cut to this same size, so the choice of dataset is purely one of subject matter.

Each row is one respondent. There are 1,868 rows and 40 columns.

Missing values

Three codes mark answers that are not usable, following the same convention as the datasets used in class:

- 998 = Don't know
- 999 = Refused, or no answer given
- −1 = Not applicable (the question did not apply to this respondent)

These codes are real numbers in the file, so they will be included in a mean or a frequency table unless you remove them. Recode them as missing before any analysis. The starter notebook shows you how.

The −1 code is worth understanding rather than simply deleting. Job satisfaction was asked only of respondents who were working, and questions about guns in the home and whether life is exciting were asked on a sub-ballot. Those respondents are coded −1, which is why satjob, life and owngun have roughly 1,250 valid answers rather than 1,860.

A note on the "n" column

The n column gives the number of respondents with a usable answer, that is, after 998, 999 and −1 have been removed. When you cross two variables, your working sample is the number of people with a usable answer on both, which will be smaller than either figure on its own. Always report the n your test actually used.

Variables

Variable	What it measures	Role	n	Values
caseid	Case identifier	id	1868	1–1868
sex	Sex	binary (t test grouping / chi-square)	1861	1=male; 2=female
age	Age in years	continuous	1824	89=89 or older
educ	Years of school completed	continuous	1862	0=no formal schooling; 1=1st grade; 2=2nd grade; 3=3rd grade; 4=4th grade; 5=5th grade; 6=6th grade; 7=7th grade; 8=8th grade; 9=9th grade; 10=10th grade; 11=11th grade; 12=12th grade; 13=1 year of college; 14=2 years of college; 15=3 years of college; 16=4 years of college; 17=5 years of college; 18=6 years of college; 19=7 years of college; 20=8 or more years of college
degree	Highest degree	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1865	0=less than high school; 1=high school; 2=associate/junior college; 3=bachelor's; 4=graduate
marital	Marital status	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1864	1=married; 2=widowed; 3=divorced; 4=separated; 5=never married
race	Race	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1837	1=white; 2=black; 3=other
hispanic	Hispanic origin	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1852	1=not hispanic; 2=mexican, mexican american, chicano/a; 3=puerto rican; 4=cuban; 5=another hispanic, latino, or spanish origin
born	Born in this country	binary (t test grouping / chi-square)	1863	1=yes; 2=no
region	Region of interview	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1868	1=northeast; 2=midwest; 3=south; 4=west
wrkstat	Labor force status	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1864	1=working full time; 2=working part time; 3=with a job, but not at work because of temporary illness, vacation, strike; 4=unemployed, laid off, looking for work; 5=retired; 6=in school; 7=keeping house; 8=other
class	Subjective social class	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1855	1=lower class; 2=working class; 3=middle class; 4=upper class
income16	Total family income (category)	ordered scale (may be treated as continuous)	1700	1=under $1,000; 2=$1,000 to $2,999; 3=$3,000 to $3,999; 4=$4,000 to $4,999; 5=$5,000 to $5,999; 6=$6,000 to $6,999; 7=$7,000 to $7,999; 8=$8,000 to $9,999; 9=$10,000 to $12,499; 10=$12,500 to $14,999; 11=$15,000 to $17,499; 12=$17,500 to $19,999; 13=$20,000 to

Variable	What it measures	Role	n	Values
				$22,499; 14=$22,500 to $24,999; 15=$25,000 to $29,999; 16=$30,000 to $34,999; 17=$35,000 to $39,999; 18=$40,000 to $49,999; 19=$50,000 to $59,999; 20=$60,000 to $74,999; 21=$75,000 to $89,999; 22=$90,000 to $109,999; 23=$110,000 to $129,999; 24=$130,000 to $149,999; 25=$150,000 to $169,999; 26=$170,000 or over
coninc	Family income in constant US dollars	continuous	1700	281.5–139,024 (US dollars)
partyid	Party identification	ordered scale (may be treated as continuous)	1855	0=strong democrat; 1=not very strong democrat; 2=independent, close to democrat; 3=independent (neither, no response); 4=independent, close to republican; 5=not very strong republican; 6=strong republican; 7=other party
polviews	Political ideology	ordered scale (may be treated as continuous)	1802	1=extremely liberal; 2=liberal; 3=slightly liberal; 4=moderate, middle of the road; 5=slightly conservative; 6=conservative; 7=extremely conservative
relig	Religious preference	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1847	1=protestant; 2=catholic; 3=jewish; 4=none; 5=other; 6=buddhism; 7=hinduism; 8=other eastern religions; 9=muslim/islam; 10=orthodox-christian; 11=christian; 12=native american; 13=inter-nondenominational
attend	Attendance at religious services	ordered scale (may be treated as continuous)	1856	0=never; 1=less than once a year; 2=about once or twice a year; 3=several times a year; 4=about once a month; 5=2-3 times a month; 6=nearly every week; 7=every week; 8=several times a week
childs	Number of children	continuous	1859	8=8 or more
polnews	How often uses media for political news	ordered scale (may be treated as continuous)	1868	1=several times a day; 2=once a day; 3=5-6 days a week; 4=3-4 days a week; 5=1-2 days a week; 6=less than 1 day a week; 7=never
compuse	Uses a computer	binary (t test grouping / chi-square)	1862	1=yes; 2=no
conpress	Confidence in the press	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1836	1=a great deal; 2=only some; 3=hardly any
contv	Confidence in television	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1844	1=a great deal; 2=only some; 3=hardly any
consci	Confidence in the scientific community	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1818	1=a great deal; 2=only some; 3=hardly any
confed	Confidence in the federal executive branch	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1830	1=a great deal; 2=only some; 3=hardly any

Variable	What it measures	Role	n	Values
conlegis	Confidence in Congress	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1840	1=a great deal; 2=only some; 3=hardly any
coneduc	Confidence in education	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1847	1=a great deal; 2=only some; 3=hardly any
conmedic	Confidence in medicine	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1845	1=a great deal; 2=only some; 3=hardly any
conbus	Confidence in major companies	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1829	1=a great deal; 2=only some; 3=hardly any
conarmy	Confidence in the military	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1840	1=a great deal; 2=only some; 3=hardly any
happy	General happiness	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1856	1=very happy; 2=pretty happy; 3=not too happy
health	Condition of health	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1864	1=excellent; 2=good; 3=fair; 4=poor
satjob	Job satisfaction	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1252	1=very satisfied; 2=moderately satisfied; 3=a little dissatisfied; 4=very dissatisfied
life	Is life exciting or dull	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1262	1=exciting; 2=routine; 3=dull
satfin	Satisfaction with financial situation	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1858	1=pretty well satisfied; 2=more or less satisfied; 3=not satisfied at all
finrela	Family income relative to others	ordered scale (may be treated as continuous)	1855	1=far below average; 2=below average; 3=average; 4=above average; 5=far above average
cantrust	Whether people can be trusted	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1791	1=people can almost always be trusted; 2=people can usually be trusted; 3=you usually can't be too careful in dealing with people; 4=you almost always can't be too careful in dealing with people
prestg10	Occupational prestige score	continuous	1761	16–80 (numeric)
vote20	Voted in the 2020 election	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1740	1=voted; 2=did not vote; 3=ineligible
owngun	Gun in the home	categorical (ANOVA factor / chi-square)	1254	1=yes; 2=no; 3=refused (treat 3 as missing)

Source: General Social Survey 2024 Cross-section (Release 3a), NORC at the University of Chicago. Full documentation and the complete codebook are available at gss.norc.org. Survey weights have been omitted from this extract, and all analyses in this course are unweighted.